



January 2008

International Flavours?

Don't you guys entertain mails from outside India? I have written several times to you and you haven't published my mails. I am from Nepal, and in our friends circle, I am the only one to read *Digit*—the others borrow from me. Thanks to you I have become the tech geek amongst my friends. They consult me for any problems they face, and I consult the magazine. The archives you gave in December have really helped in that regard. Please put more software for Linux on your DVDs. You guys do a great job.

Nitesh Rijal
Ranchi

Thanks for being a loyal reader, and yes we are planning to increase the Linux content in the DVDs, so keep an eye open for that.

Team Digit

A Faster Track

I bought *Digit* for the first time this month and I must say that the free *Fast Track* booklet was amazing. I have decided to buy *Digit* every month from now on, as long as you continue the *Fast Track* series. Is there some way in which I can buy all the previous *Fast Track* books?

A Nithianandam

Due to the popularity of the *Fast Track* series, we've received a lot of queries like yours. We'll look into finding a way that will allow you to get your hands on all the *Fast Track* books in one shot. Currently, however, we only provide PDF versions on a regular basis in the DVDs of special issues. In order to help us understand exactly how popular this feeling is, we request all readers who would like to purchase

something like a "*Fast Track Compendium*" to write to editor@thinkdigit.com and express their desire to do so.

Team Digit

A Sad Farewell

I thought that the magazine would improve with 9.9 media buying it... but it has not. The magazine contents are not that good: a review of only flash drives? I have got used to two sets of shootouts / reviews in each magazine, and I refuse to accept only one, even if you have the Zero1 Awards to print, which is just copy-pasting from previous reviews anyway.

Personally I feel the Zero1 Awards is a waste of pages. We buy the magazine the whole year anyway, so we already know what's good from the reviews, and the contenders in most of the sections of the Zero1 Awards were the previous tests runner-ups! Come on, you can do better than this. The Zero1 Awards should be a 2 or 3 page article—just name the winners and runner-ups with a little description.

Last but not least, the *Fast Track* was hopeless this month. Most of us already know all this stuff just by reading your magazine itself!

The first time I bought *Digit* in June 2001 it had in-depth reviews of firewalls, antivirus etc... It was much more technical... *Digit* is getting boring for me, and you have stepped down a level on the technical part to appeal to a broader audience. The number of pages and articles keep decreasing, and it's just 128 pages now! I won't complain about the Ads, because I know a magazine needs them to keep costs down, but don't decrease the number of pages and articles. Personally I buy the magazine for the articles and not for the stuff you give on the DVD, I can download those myself!

I am sorry to say, but I am switching to a different mag. In the end I would like to thank *Digit* for converting me into an open source and free software junkie, and moving me away from piracy. It was a nice journey, and I have been loyal to you for 7 years. My favourite article in *Digit* last year was the G80 vs R600. Give me more articles like that and I will buy *Digit* again.

Shashank Shekhar Katyayan
Ranchi

We understand the sentiment you have. However, we urge our readers to understand the rationale behind the Zero1 Awards. Let's look at this issue

of *Digit*, where we've tested cell phones and DVD writers. Now, in December 2008 or January 2009, when we announce our Zero1 Awards, for the "Best Product" award for these categories for 2008, is it fair to just give the award to the current test's winners? With technology changing almost overnight, it wouldn't be fair to either our readers or the manufacturers of cell phones and DVD writers now would it?

We know for a fact that if we awarded a product that is almost a year old with a Zero1 Award, and there was a more deserving product already available, passionate readers like you would not fail to remind us of our errors. Also, all of our tests involve telling you exactly why we choose one product over another, so doing the Zero1 awards in 3 pages is as good as us telling you, forget the other cell phones, just go out and buy a network hacked iPhone! Instead of just *telling* you what to buy, we justify it with hard facts and reviews, to help you make a better judgement for yourself.

Now, getting to the second part of your mail, it's always a sad moment for all of us when we hear readers telling us that they're moving on. The majority of our team consists of people who were *Digit* readers, and we understand what you're saying. *Digit* became India's top selling and most respected technology magazine because of its innovations and because it filled a rather large void in our lives. It can take you from being bored in front of the PC playing *Solitaire* and make you so passionate about technology that you soon find yourself employed as a technology professional!

We're not going to try and kid ourselves, we can't please *everyone*, but we will try our level best to get you interested in *Digit* again, and soon. We're also very happy to hear that you've gone off piracy, and are glad to have been the catalyst for that. Thanks for the loyalty, we truly appreciate it, and hope to soon see a mail from you like the one that follows...

Team Digit

You Will Make Me Fail

I am an MBBS student, and just another fan of *Digit*, the greatest IT magazine in India. I have to tell you that *Digit* is becoming more and more informative and interesting every month. When I bring it home at the beginning of every month, I can't stop reading it—sometimes I read it all through the night! Then the next day I just read it all over again. Now you can imagine what happens...

Like I said, I'm an MBBS student, so what am I doing reading a tech magazine, and not touching a single text book. I guess you can see how

Write to the Editor

E-mail: editor@thinkdigit.com

Snail Mail: The Editor, Digit, KPT House, Plot 41/13, Sector 30, Vashi, Navi Mumbai 400 703

Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

For subscription queries send an e-mail to help@jasubhai.com

interesting I find your magazine to be. But please, try not to make it any better, or I'm going to fail!

The January issue was great, especially the *Fast Track*. This was perfect for people like me, who have no IT background. Thanks to the *Fast Track to Tech Jargon*, I can hold conversations about technology with my engineering friends with confidence! Thank you so much for that.

Bhushan Thombre
Nagpur

Unfortunately, Bhushan, although we love our doctors, we think it's time you switched professions. Sadly, we've already promised everyone that we're going to get even better, even if it means causing one of our beloved readers to fail his exams! Still, we hope you pass with flying colours, and wish you best of luck for your exams.

Team Digit

Open Up That Source

I have been purchasing *Digit* every month since January 2000, (when it was called *Chip*). The couriers refuse to deliver to my remote location, which is why I cannot subscribe, and have to buy it from the stalls. *Wars of The Future* (January 2008) was a really interesting read. I actually believed that it was a true story written by a hacker himself, until I noticed the January 2013 date! Also, the tip about using the GreaseMonkey script was great, and I have been looking for such a plug-in for a long time.

I also appreciate your drive to increase awareness against piracy. The best way to do that is promote Linux and OSS. The inclusion of a Linux distro in the DVD is a positive step, but there is still a part you are overlooking—making the CD and DVD user friendly to Linux users like me. I really hate to boot into Windows just to browse the disks. I do love the disk UI though, and the cool background music. I have a suggestion though, why not put an SWF version of the UI on the discs as well, so at least us Linux users can browse the disk and use the UI—even if we cannot install the software.

Nirupam Biswas
Ranchi, Jharkhand

We've been pondering the same points you're making for a while now, and are working on a solution for our Linux-based readers. Hopefully we'll have something concrete rolled out in a few

months. We're glad you like the UI for the discs, as some of us slaved day and night for over two months creating it.

Team Digit

Warriors Of The Future?

I am a regular reader, and I must say the January issue is wonderful. The *Wars Of The Future* article was very interesting and informative. After reading this article I have found a strange desire within myself to become a hacker and protect Indian servers. Please tell me, are there any courses that will help me become a hacker?

I'd also like to suggest that you increase the frequency of mobile content in your magazine—such as mobile accessories and the latest software for mobiles and PDAs.

Raju Kumar
Bihar

We thank you for the positive feedback, and are glad it appealed to your patriotic nature. There are no courses that will teach you "hacking", which is often considered an art form of sorts. Every "hacker", ethical or otherwise, is a programmer and does immense amounts of research and learning. You need tremendous networking knowledge and know everything there is to know about the C (C, C++, etc.) languages. You can aspire to work for Indian security specialist firms and become an "ethical hacker", which is basically testing and fixing the security of Indian servers and sites.

Team Digit

I Love You Digit

Everyone in *Team Digit* is like the drops of water that make the sea. I am proud of your all. I really love the *Digit Diary* section. Please keep injecting tech fuel into me. I was really sad to bid Deepak Ajwani adieu, and though I have never met him, I actually cried. I guess I love *Digit* that much.

Pankaj Kumar
Rourkela, Orissa

That's the most emotional letter we've received. Just when we thought we'd heard it all you come along proclaiming your undying love. All we can say is, whether our other readers share your feelings or not, we love all our readers unconditionally as well!

Team Digit

Whoops!

I was reading through your article about Pen drives, and unfortunately find that the article is very badly put up. There are a lot of comments that have gone haywire at different points of time.

To quote some: On Page 68, in the Slightly Overweight 2GB features, it was mentioned about the Kingston Data Traveler Reader, that "*It's not built very well though.*", but in the table on page 71, in the comments row, the plus point says "*+ Well built*". Now this is really a contrast. Either one of the statements is not true.

In the 8 GB section, the Buffalo Turbo with a price of Rs 5,220 has a minus point of "*- Costly*", but at the same time, the Sandisk Cruzer with a price of Rs 7,990 is said to be "*- None in particular*". This seems that the additional Rs 2,500 that you pay for Sandisk is justified—how? Their speeds don't really show any difference, and in fact the Sandisk is slower than the Buffalo.

I don't mean to demean what you have written, but when a person looks at these tables, or what's written in a magazine as revered as *Digit*, it's taken as the words of the Gods of technology. We rate your magazine very highly, and errors like this don't look good.

It looks like the proof reader was half-asleep as well: the contact sheet on page 75 is totally out of order.

Anyways, the tests are really helpful to me. I own a 1 GB Transcend V10, which I bought three years ago. And thankfully, it's still working great. I am impressed with the performance tests of the V10, as it outperforms the V30 and V60!

Overall, I would still like to thank Michael Browne for a great article.

Vincent Thomas
Bangalore

Sorry about the contact sheet, it's obvious something went horribly wrong there.

As for your first comment, I think you're getting mixed up with the Kingston DataTraveler and the Kingston DataTraveler Reader 2GB, which is right next to it in the table. No errors there as far as we can see.

The second error you've caught is spot on, and we've goofed up. It's readers like you who keep us on our toes, and we'll try our level best to not give you cause for complaints in the future.

Team Digit

